



# The Seychelles

*More than 100 tropical islands of remarkable beauty, home to the world's rarest palm and one of the largest raised coral atolls on Earth*



## △ TIDAL CHANNELS

On Aldabra Atoll, channeling tides have created many habitats, including a saline lagoon, mangrove swamps, and seagrass beds that support numerous aquatic species.

The Seychelles' 115 tropical islands lie off the east coast of Africa in the western Indian Ocean and are divided into two groups. Most of the 41 mountainous granite Inner Islands are located 4° south of the equator and are projections of the large undersea Mascarene Plateau that extends south to Réunion. Among the Inner Islands is Praslin, whose

Vallée de Mai World Heritage Site contains Earth's largest forest of endangered coco-de-mer palms. In contrast, the low-lying, coralline Outer Islands are situated beyond the plateau, 10° south of the equator, and include the Aldabra group, a raised coral atoll that has been a designated nature reserve since 1976.

More than **152,000**  
**Aldabra giant tortoises**  
live on the atoll

## ▷ DOUBLE COCONUT

The coco-de-mer is endemic to the islands of Praslin and Curieuse. Its double coconut is the heaviest seed on Earth and takes seven years to ripen.

